

help each other out. The Web site works on a simple philosophy where as a user; you can post a question, which may be answered by fellow users or browse questions in order to answer them. The Yahoo! Answers service is free and can be logged into from your Yahoo! Account id.

The Yahoo! Answers Web site categorises every question into a multitude of sub-categories. There are a wide range of categories to choose from on the Web site, from “Arts & Humanities”, “Beauty & Style” to the more serious “Politics & Government” variety. They also have a section called “Best of Answers” which catalogues all the best answers that questions have received.

Creating Your Profile

As soon as you log into the Web site and are ready to ask your question, you are confronted with a page to create your online profile first. Here, the user can create a username, customise their avatar and specify an e-mail address to which he is notified when his question receives an answer.

Asking A Question

After logging into the site, to ask a question, just click onto the ‘ask’ tab in the new page that opens up, you can enter your question and add more details. After clicking ‘next’, you get to categorise your question into various sub-directories. What impressed us most about this step is that Yahoo! Answers gave a list of the most probable categorisations, automatically choosing the best option every time! Once that is done, the site allows you to preview how your question will look and gives you the option of modifying it. When that is done, you can select ‘OK’.

Scoring

To increase competition and improve the quality of answers on the site, there is a scoring system which users can compete for. The score indicates how reputable or helpful a user you have been in the community. Also, when you answer a question, your score increases. Users can vote for the best answer to a question